

PASSAGE 16

Many poor farmers had been compelled to take up indigo cultivation, when the British settlers were given the right to purchase and cultivate land in India. Many whites, therefore, either acquired land or advanced loans to poor farmers and pressurised them to forsake the farming of foodgrains and other cash crops for indigo cultivation. Indigo export to Europe was lucrative for the British settlers who held a monopoly of this business.

Within a few years, most of the fertile lands had undergone forcible indigo cultivation, resulting in a famine situation in Bengal. When the farmers declined to cultivate indigo, they were tortured, jailed and even killed.

51. The poor farmers in Bengal took up indigo cultivation because
 - (a) the government encouraged them to do so
 - (b) it was a money earning crop
 - (c) they were forced to do so
 - (d) this was the only crop that would grow in that region
52. British settlers bought land in Bengal in order to
 - (a) introduce cultivation of cash crops in India
 - (b) cultivate indigo
 - (c) settle down in India
 - (d) promote export business in Bengal
53. Indigo export was profitable for the British settlers because
 - (a) they had no competitors
 - (b) the crop yield was good
 - (c) they could oppress the farmers
 - (d) the labour was cheap

PASSAGE 17

The first day out we met our first rhino, two of them and I had the fright of my life. The pair had our scent before we spotted them and being bad tempered beasts, they rushed towards where they thought we were. Now it just happened that we were about fifty yards to one side of where they expected to find us-which was just as well, for I must say I did not like their look. As they thundered past, we crouched low and let them go. It did not strike me as a good opportunity for rhino photography. Anyhow, I was much too frightened to have been able to hold the camera steady.

54. From the above passage, it appears that rhinos
 - (a) run away when they see human beings
 - (b) rush to attack when they smell human scent
 - (c) hide under the bushes at the sight of human beings
 - (d) stand still if they are not attacked
55. When the author saw a rhino for the first time, he was
 - (a) excited
 - (b) frightened
 - (c) charmed
 - (d) surprised

56. The author could not take the photographs of the rhinos because
 - (a) he was too far away from rhinos
 - (b) he was not carrying a good camera
 - (c) it did not occur to him that he had a chance to do so
 - (d) he did not like the look of rhinos

2013 (II)

PASSAGE 18

A well-dressed young man entered a big textile shop one evening. He was able to draw the attention of the salesmen who thought him rich and likely to make heavy purchases. He was shown the superior varieties of suit lengths and sarees. But after casually examining them, he kept moving to the next section, where readymade goods were being sold and further on to the hosiery section. By then, the salesmen had begun to doubt his intentions and drew the attention of the manager.

The manager asked him what exactly he wanted and he replied that he wanted courteous treatment. He explained that he had come to the same shop in casual dress that morning and drawn little attention. His pride was hurt and he wanted to assert himself. He had come in good dress only to get decent treatment, not for getting any textiles. He left without making any purchase.

57. The young man was well-dressed because
 - (a) it was his habit to dress well
 - (b) it was his wedding day
 - (c) he wanted to meet the manager of the shop
 - (d) he wanted to impress the salesmen
58. The salesmen in the shop are described as people who pay attention to
 - (a) only young men and women
 - (b) pretty women
 - (c) only rich customers
 - (d) regular customers
59. The young man moved away to the hosiery section because he
 - (a) was not interested in purchasing anything now
 - (b) did not like the readymade clothes
 - (c) wanted better clothes
 - (d) was restless
60. The manager asked the young man what he wanted because
 - (a) he would give him exactly what he was looking for
 - (b) the salesman had drawn his attention to the indifferent attitude of the young man
 - (c) he thought they could do more business with him that way
 - (d) he thought the visitor was dissatisfied

- 61.** The young man left without making purchases because he
- did not have money
 - could not find any item of his choice
 - had come only to make a point about the indifferent attitude of the salesmen towards casually dressed customers
 - decided to come to make the purchases later on

PASSAGE 19

The prisoner awaited his chance. For three solid years, he had schemed for this opportunity. Now that escape seemed so near at hand, those three years lost some of their monotony. But he would never forget the lashes, the close confinement, low diet and worse still the mental strain of those black days. Suddenly, the warden did what he had hoped. He stopped to unlock the lower padlock.

With a dull thud he slumped forward with keys in his hands. Swiftly the prisoner seized his keys, unlocked the cell and ran into the courtyard. It took him four seconds to reach the rope-ladder secretly placed there by his accomplices, five more to clamber over the wall, and three more to jump into the waiting car to be whisked away to freedom. Even though he was guilty, the prisoner felt he had paid for his crime, for the man he had robbed three years ago was still a millionaire.

- 62.** For what crime had the prisoner been punished?
- Murder
 - Arson
 - Robbery
 - Kidnapping
- 63.** When had the crime been committed?
- Just before the escape
 - Three years earlier
 - Long ago
 - Day earlier
- 64.** Who slumped forward with a dull thud?
- The millionaire
 - The warden
 - The prisoner
 - Prisoner's accomplice
- 65.** What did the prisoner suffer the most during imprisonment?
- Poor health
 - Mental strain
 - Physical torture
 - Absence from his family

PASSAGE 20

Nationalism is only a curse when it becomes narrow and fanatical. Like so many other things available to man, say, religion, it can easily lead men astray. Nationalism can lead people into thinking only of themselves, of their own struggles, of their own misery. It can also cause a nation to become suspicious and fearful of its neighbours, to look upon itself as superior and to become aggressive and it is when nationalism impels a state to become expansionist and seek domination over others that it becomes a positive curse and harmful internationally.

- 66.** From the passage, which of the following statements most correctly reflects the opinion of the author?
- Nationalism makes people self-centered and self-conceited
 - It helps a nation to become superior to other nations
 - It regulates international relationships
 - It helps a nation to expand its territories and become powerful
- 67.** Which of the following phrases most correctly suggests the central theme of the passage?
- Nationalism and religion
 - Nationalism as an inspiration for development
 - Nationalism as a cause of war
 - Evils of narrow and aggressive nationalism
- 68.** From the passage, which of the following statements can be assumed to be most likely to be true?
- The author believes that nationalism is always a curse
 - He believes that it is possible for men to misuse religion
 - He thinks that religion always leads men astray
 - He pleads for a mix-up of religion and nationalism

PASSAGE 21

Brown and his men, huddling round a fire, ate the last of the food that Kassim had brought them that day. Cornelius sat among them, half-asleep. Then, one of the crew remembered that some tobacco had been left in the boat, and said he would go and fetch it. He did not think there was any danger in going to the creek in the dark. He disappeared down the hillside and a moment later he was heard climbing into the boat and then climbing out again.

- 69.** Consider the following statements
- Brown and Cornelius sat round the fire.
 - Cornelius lay half-asleep at a little distance from the fire.
 - All the people sat round the fire.
- Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?*
- 1 and 2
 - Only 2
 - Only 3
 - 1 and 3
- 70.** One of them disappeared down the hill implies that
- the slope of the hill was slippery
 - he fell from the edge of the hill
 - there was suddenly a sea beside the hill
 - he walked down the hill
- 71.** 'He didn't think in the dark.' This sentence actually implies that he
- was bold and adventurous
 - was addicted to smoking
 - would face some trouble
 - was the only person who knew where in the boat tobacco was
- 72.** What does the word 'huddling' imply?
- Moving around
 - Falling into a slumber
 - Being close together
 - Merrymaking

PASSAGE 22

As soon as I saw the elephant I knew with perfect certainty that I ought not to shoot him. It is a serious matter to shoot a working elephant. It is comparable to destroying a huge and costly piece of machinery and obviously one ought not to do it if it can possibly be avoided. And at that distance, peacefully eating, the elephant looked no more dangerous than a cow.

- 73.** The writer was against shooting the elephant because
- (a) he suspected it to be a wild one and was afraid of it
 - (b) his heart was full of compassion for animals
 - (c) he was certain that the elephant was innocent
 - (d) it would amount to avoidable waste of useful property
- 74.** The author compares the elephant to a costly machine because
- (a) ivory is very expensive
 - (b) it can do as much work as an expensive machine
 - (c) elephants look like big machines
 - (d) elephants and machines have similar prices
- 75.** The elephant looked no more dangerous than a cow because
- (a) it was quietly doing its work
 - (b) unlike lions, it is a vegetarian animal
 - (c) its tusks resemble the cow's horns
 - (d) cows can be very dangerous sometimes

PASSAGE 23

I was very fond of the old soldier in our little town. He had only one leg, having lost the other somewhere in Assam in 1942. He used to tell me about his adventures. He told me that he had run away from home to join the army. He had experienced his first battle in the Libyan desert. Out of his dozens of war stories, the one I liked best was the one of his escape from a Japanese prison-of-war camp in Burma. He told me again and again how he walked two hundred miles in two weeks. On the way he was bitten on the toe by a poisonous snake and he had to cut off part of the toe in order to survive. But by the time he got to an Indian camp the wound had turned septic and the leg had to be amputated. He is, however, quite contented with his lot.

- 76.** The author was very fond of the old soldier because
- (a) he had lost one of his legs in war
 - (b) he used to tell the author about his adventures
 - (c) he was contented with his lot
 - (d) he had been to many countries
- 77.** Why did the old soldier repeatedly tell that he walked two hundred miles?
- (a) He ran away from home to join the army
 - (b) He had to cross the Libyan desert
 - (c) He had to escape from a prison-of-war camp
 - (d) He was a strong soldier

- 78.** The story of the old soldier that the author liked most was that about
- (a) his running away from home to join the army
 - (b) his first battle in the Libyan desert
 - (c) the loss of his leg in Assam
 - (d) his escape from a Japanese prison-of-war camp
- 79.** The old soldier, according to the author, was
- (a) unhappy about his life
 - (b) satisfied with his lot
 - (c) angry about his fate
 - (d) disgusted with his misfortune
- 80.** The soldier's leg had to be amputated because
- (a) he had walked two hundred miles in two weeks
 - (b) he was wounded in war
 - (c) the wounded toe turned septic
 - (d) he was shot in the leg while escaping from the Japanese camp

PASSAGE 24

A large number of people had come to attend the meeting to be addressed by the gifted speaker. The organisers had a difficult time keeping the assembled people quiet as the meeting did not commence at the scheduled time.

After some time, the people lost their patience and began to shout and heckle. The organisers had great difficulty in assuaging the anger of the crowd when they were forced to cancel the meeting as the speaker had to be hospitalised due to sudden illness.

- 81.** What was the actual reason for the organisers to have a difficult time?
- (a) A large number of people had come to the meeting
 - (b) The organisers could not make proper arrangements
 - (c) The meeting could not be started in time
 - (d) The speaker was ill
- 82.** What does the word 'assuaging' imply?
- (a) Accepting
 - (b) Tolerating
 - (c) Reducing
 - (d) Removing
- 83.** Further delay resulted in the people
- (a) leaving the place
 - (b) fighting with the organisers
 - (c) making noise
 - (d) making the speaker ill

2014 (I)

PASSAGE 25

Those responsible for teaching young people have resorted to a variety of means to make their pupils learn. The earliest of these was the threat of punishment. This meant that the pupil who was slow, careless or inattentive risked either physical chastisement or the loss of some expected privilege. Learning was thus associated with fear.

At a later period, pupils were encouraged to learn in the hope of some kind of reward. This often took the form of marks awarded for work done and sometimes of prizes given at the end of the year to the best scholar. Such a system appealed to the competitive spirit, but was just as depressing as the older system for the slow pupil.

In the 19th century sprang up a new type of teacher, convinced that learning was worthwhile for its own sake and that the young pupil's principal stimulus should neither be anxiety to avoid a penalty nor ambition to win a reward, but sheer desire to learn. Interest, direct or indirect, became the keyword of instruction.

- 84.** The educational system which caused fear in the second mind was based on
 (a) rewards (b) labour
 (c) punishment (d) competition
- 85.** The system based on rewards satisfied all except
 (a) the slow pupil
 (b) the very intelligent pupil
 (c) the laborious pupil
 (d) the casual pupil
- 86.** The system which appealed to the competitive spirit in the pupils was largely based on
 (a) punishment (b) marks
 (c) chastisement (d) cash prizes

PASSAGE 26

On a surface which is free from obstacles, such as a clear road or a path, only two or three species of snakes can hope to catch up with a human being, even if they are foolish to try. A snake seems to move very fast but its movements are deceptive. In spite of the swift, wave-like motions of its body, the snake crawls along the ground at no more than the speed of man's walk. It may, however, have an advantage inside a jungle, where the progress of a man is obstructed by thorny bushes. But in such places, the footsteps of a man are usually more than enough to warn snakes to keep away. Although they have no ears of the usual kind, they can feel slight vibrations on the ground through their bodies, and thus get an early warning of danger.

- 87.** The snake has an advantage over men inside a jungle, because there
 (a) it can crawl faster
 (b) it gets advance warning
 (c) man's movement is obstructed
 (d) it is dark inside a jungle
- 88.** What helps the snakes to receive advance warning is their sensitivity to
 (a) obstacles in the path
 (b) smell of other beings
 (c) sounds made by other beings
 (d) movements of other beings

PASSAGE 27

This rule of always trying to do things as well as one can do them has an important bearing upon the problem of ambition.

No man or woman should be without ambition, which is the inspiration of activity. But if one allows ambition to drive one to attempt things which are beyond one's own personal capacity, then unhappiness will result. If one imagines that one can do everything better than other people, then envy and jealousy, those twin monsters, will come to sadden one's days. But if one concentrates one's attention upon developing one's own special capacities, the things one is best at, then one does not worry over much if other people are more successful.

- 89.** Which one of the following alternatives brings out the meaning of 'to have a bearing upon' clearly?
 (a) To have an effect on
 (b) To carry the weight on oneself
 (c) To put up with
 (d) To decrease friction
- 90.** Which one of the following statements is correct?
 (a) There is a close relationship between ambition and activity
 (b) Ambition and activity belong to two different areas
 (c) Ambition is useless
 (d) Activity is responsible for ambition
- 91.** The statement 'if one allows ambition to drive one to attempt things which are beyond one's own personal capacity, then unhappiness will result,' means that
 (a) one must always try to do less than one's capacity
 (b) one must always try to do more than one's capacity
 (c) ambition must be consistent with one's capacity
 (d) there should be no ambition at all
- 92.** Which one of the following statements best reflects the underlying tone of the passage?
 (a) One must do everything as well as one can
 (b) One must try to be better than others
 (c) One must continuously worry about others
 (d) One must try beyond one's capacity to get results
- 93.** Which one of the following statements can be assumed to be true?
 (a) It is good to imagine oneself better than others
 (b) One should not imagine oneself always to be better than others
 (c) All persons have equal capacity
 (d) One should have more ambition than others

PASSAGE 28

An earthquake comes like a thief in the night, without warning. It was necessary, therefore to invent instruments that neither slumbered nor slept. Some devices were quite simple. One, for instance, consisted of rods of various lengths and thicknesses which would stand up on end like ninepins. When a shock came it shook the rigid table upon which these stood.

If it were gentle, only the more unstable rods fell. If it were severe, they all fell. Thus, the rods by falling and by the direction in which they fell, recorded for the slumbering scientist, the strength of a shock that was too weak to waken him and the direction from which it came. But, instruments far more delicate than that were needed if any really serious advance was to be made.

The ideal to be aimed at was to devise an instrument that could record with a pen on paper the movements, of the ground or of the table, as the quake passed by. While I write my pen moves but the paper keeps still. With practice, no doubt, I could, in time, learn to write by holding the pen still while the paper moved.

That sounds a silly suggestion, but that was precisely the idea adopted in some of the early instruments (seismometers) for recording earthquake waves. But when table, penholder and paper are all moving how is it possible to write legibly? The key to a solution of that problem lay in an everyday observation. Why does a person standing in a bus or train tend to fall when a sudden start is made? It is because his feet move on, but his head stays still.

- 94.** The passage says that early instruments for measuring earthquakes were
- faulty in design
 - expensive
 - not sturdy
 - not sensitive enough
- 95.** Why was it necessary to invent instruments to observe an earthquake?
- Because an earthquake comes like a thief in the night
 - To make people alert about earthquakes during their conscious as well as unconscious hours
 - To prove that we are technically advanced
 - To experiment with the control of man over nature
- 96.** A simple device which consisted of rods that stood up on end like ninepins was replaced by a more sophisticated one because it failed
- to measure a gentle earthquake
 - to measure a severe earthquake
 - to record the direction of the earthquake
 - to record the facts with a pen on paper
- 97.** The everyday observation referred to in the passage relates to
- a moving bus or train
 - the sudden start of a bus
 - the tendency of a standing person to fall when a bus or train moves suddenly
 - people standing in a bus or train
- 98.** The early seismometers adopted the idea that in order to record the earthquake, it is
- the pen that should move just as it moves when we write on paper
 - the pen that should stay still and the paper should move
 - both pen and paper that should move
 - neither pen nor paper that should move

2014 (II)

PASSAGE 29

During the summer I was introduced to the game of cricket, and I felt my inherent foreignness for the first time. The ball is far too hard for my taste. Even during my last games at the school, angry spectators would shout, "Butter fingers !" But I smiled. Everyone knew in their hearts that I was going to drop the ball anyway, and nobody expected me to be able to play the game.

- 99.** The author first played cricket
- as a child in his own country
 - when he was a school boy
 - when he was a tourist
 - when he returned home after his studies
- 100.** "Felt my inherent foreignness" means
- felt very strange
 - felt very interested and excited
 - enjoyed learning new games
 - felt my superiority over others
- 101.** Spectators would shout "Butter fingers" when the author was playing because
- he liked butter
 - his fingers were like those of a lady
 - he often dropped the ball
 - he was very good at the game
- 102.** 'Spectator' means
- glasses
 - onlookers
 - watchman
 - player

PASSAGE 30

How can you improve your reading speed? By taking off the brakes. You wouldn't think of driving a car with the brake on. Yet as a reader you probably have several brakes slowing you down.

One very common brake is regressing— looking back every now and then at something already read. It is like stepping backwards every few metres as you walk— hardly the way to move ahead quickly. Regression may arise from a lack of confidence, vocabulary deficiency, or actually missing a word or phrase. It makes a long sentence seem even more complex as the eyes frequently regress.

Eye movement photographs of 12000 readers in America showed that university students regress an average of 15 times in reading only 100 words. The average student of class four was found to look back 20 times. In short, regression consumes one-sixth of your precious reading time. Release this brake and enjoy a spurt in reading speed.